

has happened. I think India has demonstrated it in a wonderful manner and the whole world is also following that particular model. Further, on the offtake risk, there is an aggregation of demand and an assurance of payments coming in from government-led institutions, which is a great learning for the whole world. Then there are insurance products that are trying to cover different kinds of risks associated with this sector. I think whatever risk mitigation measures financial institution look for, they are all available. Just to explain the kind of complexity a project can have: one of our major customers is implementing a project in Australia, which was conceived in the UK, and is being funded by [South] Korean entities. It is coming up

that renewable energy flows to the user through electricity boards. Now, till the time you have a commercial entity that decides what is to be supplied and how much, all your efforts get bottlenecked at that point. I can tell you one thing, there is a pile of money waiting in the pipeline to be invested in Indian IPPs [independent power producers], and you are not getting it because they [investors] are saying 'You did the bidding in 2019 and we are still waiting for the PPA [power purchase agreement] to be signed in 2020-end. And I do not know whether in 2021-22, we will be able to start the project.' Why? Who decides that the project will come up finally? It's the electricity boards. So, till the time you bring a commercial entity there, we will struggle in terms of transition.

segment are meant to be related to these things.

Q: When will we see the end user really utilising solar as a viable option?

SHILPA URHEKAR, NATIONAL HEAD-DOMESTIC, STERLING AND WILSON RENEWABLE ENERGY LTD: I believe that unless we give the consumer an option which is better than the existing option, you cannot expect wide adoption. So what you need to do is not just the products, but a system that has two-way communication. A system that has power as well as communication and the net metering model—which had started long ago in Germany—will lead to wider adoption for rooftop solar. In India, if we want to achieve that, then our grids need to be

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in Western Australia and being supported by an Indian financial institution as well, so this is the global situation we are looking at.

Q: How significant has this transition been in India if you were to compare it globally and how far do we have to walk?

RAJ KUMAR ROY, MD & CEO, AMPYR ENERGY: We have been the world leader in achieving sustainable tariffs, perhaps the lowest in the world. Have we gone through the transition mode? Perhaps not. The biggest reason is

Q: How far are we from solar being mainstream in India as far as the average retail consumer is concerned?

SUNIL BADESRA, COUNTRY HEAD, SUNGROW INDIA PVT. LTD:

In the past few years, we have seen people gaining a lot of knowledge about the solar industry. If you talk about recent times, many new components are coming in, but I think it's all about gradual adoption. There are many solar products that are already in the market, so I am hopeful that a lot of the products that we see in the solar

much more sustainable than they are. And the other point is to apply where it is working, where it is needed and in which industry. The country has a huge opportunity to switch to renewable energy as a source; for example, wherever there are heat requirements, generate that heat from renewable energy instead of fossil fuels.

Q: On energy storage... ANISH MANDAL, PARTNER, DELOITTE INDIA:

The entire energy transition could be solved if you have energy storage. So that's the verdict. We all know that